

Word family: **get / gets / got / gotten / getting / getter / go-getter**

Base word: get

Past tense: got

Past participle: **got** (especially British English) / **gotten** (especially American English in many senses)

-ing form: getting

Useful family extension: go-getter

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...the train was so noisy and crowded that I often **got home** feeling exhausted."

A full family sweep confirms that **get is one of the richest and most polysemous verbs in everyday English**. It is absolutely one of the biggest words we nearly missed.

Its meanings include:

- * receive
- * obtain/buy
- * become
- * arrive
- * understand
- * catch an illness
- * earn/score
- * fetch/bring
- * persuade/cause
- * arrange for something to be done
- * experience something
- * have an opportunity
- * reach a stage
- * and several important grammatical constructions

I'll keep **phrasal verbs excluded by default**, as per our rule, so I will not expand into *get over, get through, get away, get along,* etc.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

> **got home**

means:

****arrived home / reached home****

****繁體中文： ** **到家；回到家中****

Natural translation:

> “I often got home feeling exhausted.”

「我經常****回到家時已經覺得筋疲力盡****。」

So here:

****get + destination = 到達某個地方****

and specifically:

****get home = 到家****

1. ****get + destination (目的地) — 到達；抵達****

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I often ****got home**** feeling exhausted.”

「我經常****回到家****時已經筋疲力盡。」

Practice 2

> “What time did you ****get home**** last night?”

「你昨晚幾點****到家****？」

Practice 3

> “We ****got to the station**** just before the train left.”

「我們在火車開出前剛好****到達車站****。」

****get + destination = 經過移動後到達某個地方****

Important grammar: **get home**, not *get to home*

Just like:

* go home

* come home

* get home

we normally say:

> **get home** 

not:

> *get to home* 

But with ordinary destinations:

> get **to the office**

> get **to school**

> get **to the station**

2. **get + object (東西 / 資訊 / 機會) — 得到 ; 取得 ; 獲得**

This is one of the central meanings.

Practice 4

> “I **got** an email from the company.”

「我**收到**公司寄來的一封信。」

Practice 5

> “She **got** permission to leave early.”

「她**獲准**提早離開。」

get something = 得到、收到或取得某樣東西、資訊、機會或權利

Chinese varies naturally:

* get a message → 收到訊息

* get permission → 獲得批准

* get a chance → 得到機會

3. **get + product/item (商品 / 物件) — 買到 ; 取得 ; 弄到**

Depending on context, **get** can mean **buy, obtain, acquire**.

Practice 6

> “I need to **get** a new charger.”

「我需要**買 / 弄一個新的充電器**。」

Practice 7

> “Where did you **get** those headphones?”

「你在哪裡**買到 / 弄到**那副耳機？」

get something = 透過購買、取得或其他方式把某物弄到手

This is broader than **buy**.

4. **get + adjective (狀態) — 變得..... ; 進入某種狀態**

A hugely important construction.

Practice 8

> “I **got tired** after the long journey.”

「長途旅程後我**變得很累**。」

Practice 9

> “It's **getting cold**.”

「天氣**正在變冷**。」

get + adjective = 從原本狀態轉變成新的狀態

Common:

* get tired = 變累
* get angry = 生氣起來
* get cold = 變冷
* get better = 好轉
* get worse = 惡化
* get busy = 忙起來

5. **get + comparative (比較級) — 變得更.....**

A very common branch of #4.

Practice 10

> “The noise **got louder**.”

「噪音**變得更大聲**。」

Practice 11

> “The situation is **getting better**.”

「情況正在**好轉**。」

get + comparative = 某種性質隨時間變得程度更高 / 更低

6. **get + illness/problem (疾病 / 身體狀況) — 患上 ; 染上 ; 得到**

Practice 12

> “I **got a cold** last week.”

「我上星期**感冒了**。」

Practice 13

> “He **got food poisoning** while travelling.”

「他旅行期間**食物中毒了**。」

get + illness = 患上 / 感染某種疾病或身體問題

Very common conversational English.

7. **get + result/score/grade (結果 / 分數 / 成績) — 得到 ; 取得**

Practice 14

> “She **got** a high score.”

「她**取得了高分**。」

Practice 15

> “What did you **get** in the exam?”

「你考試**拿到甚麼成績**？」

get + result = 在考試、比賽或評核中取得某個結果 / 分數

8. **get + money/pay/income (錢 / 薪酬) — 賺得 ; 收到**

Practice 16

> “How much do you **get** paid?”

「你的薪金是多少 / 你**領多少薪水**？」

Practice 17

> “He **gets** a bonus every year.”

「他每年都會**獲得一筆獎金**。」

get money/pay = 收到或獲得金錢、薪酬或報酬

9. **get + meaning/joke/idea (意思 / 笑話 / 概念) — 明白 ; 理解**

This is extremely common conversational English.

Practice 18

> “I don’t **get** the joke.”

「我**不明白**這個笑話好笑在哪裡**。**」

Practice 19

> “Do you **get** what I mean?”

「你**明白**我的意思嗎**？**」

get = 理解某個意思、概念、笑話或情況**。**

Register: informal/conversational.

Compare:

> understand = 中性 / 較正式

> get = 非常自然的口語

10. **get** + person + object (替某人取得 / 拿來) — 拿；取；買來**。**

Practice 20

> “Can you **get** me some water**?**”

「你可以**替我**拿些水來**嗎？**」

Practice 21

> “I’ll **get** you a coffee**.**”

「我去**替你**買 / 拿一杯咖啡**。**」

get someone something = 替某人取得、購買或拿來某物**。**

This often overlaps with:

* fetch

* buy

* bring

depending on context.

11. **get + object + for + person (替某人取得東西) — 替.....弄到 / 買到**

Practice 22

> “I **got a ticket for** my friend.”

「我**替朋友弄到 / 買了一張票**。」

Practice 23

> “Could you **get some food for** us?”

「你可以**替我們買 / 拿些食物**嗎？」

get something for someone = 為某人取得、購買或拿來某物

12. **get + person + to + verb (使 / 說服某人做.....) — 讓 ; 說服 ; 使得**

This is a major grammar pattern.

Practice 24

> “I **got him to help** me.”

「我**說服 / 叫他幫我**。」

Practice 25

> “She **got the technician to check** the computer.”

「她**叫技術人員檢查**電腦。」

get someone to do something = 透過要求、說服或安排，使某人做某事

Compare:

> make someone do

> = 強迫 / 使某人做

> get someone to do

> = 設法讓 / 說服某人做

13. **get + object + adjective (令某物變成某狀態) — 使.....變得.....**

Practice 26

> “We need to **get the room ready**.”

「我們需要**把房間準備好**。」

Practice 27

> “Try to **get the surface clean**.”

「嘗試**把表面清理乾淨**。」

get something + adjective = 使某物進入指定狀態

14. **get + object + past participle (安排某事被做) — 找人 / 安排把.....做好**

A very important causative construction.

Practice 28

> “I need to **get my phone repaired**.”

「我需要**找人修理我的電話**。」

Practice 29

> “She **got her hair cut** yesterday.”

「她昨天**去剪了頭髮 / 找人幫她剪頭髮**。」

get something done = 安排 / 請別人把某件事情完成

Usually the subject does **not** personally perform the action.

15. **get + object + past participle (遭遇某事) — 遭到 ; 被.....**

The same structure can also express an experience rather than an arrangement.

Practice 30

> “He **got his wallet stolen**.”

「他的錢包**被偷了**。」

Practice 31

> “She **got her bag damaged** on the flight.”

「她的袋子在航班途中**被弄壞了**。」

get something done — experience = 某人的東西遭受某個通常不希望發生的動作

Context distinguishes this from the causative meaning.

16. **get + past participle (本人進入被動 / 結果狀態) — 被..... ; 變成.....**

This is often called the **get-passive**.

Practice 32

> “He **got injured** during the match.”

「他在比賽中**受傷了**。」

Practice 33

> “They **got caught** in the rain.”

「他們**遇上大雨 / 被雨淋到了**。」

get + past participle = 某人進入某種由事件造成的狀態，常帶有變化或意外感

Compare:

> was injured

> = 被 / 受傷 (中性)

> got injured

> = 弄傷 / 受了傷 (更動態、更口語)

17. **get to + verb (有機會 / 獲准做.....) — 有機會 ; 可以**

Practice 34

> “I **got to meet** the designer.”

「我**有機會見到**那位設計師。」

Practice 35

> “Employees **get to work** from home twice a week.”

「員工每星期**有機會 / 可以**在家工作兩天。」

get to do something = 得到機會或被允許去做某事

18. **get to + person** (情緒上影響某人) — 令某人心煩 / 受影響

This is a useful non-phrasal idiomatic construction.

Practice 36

> “Don’t let the criticism **get to you**.”

「不要讓那些批評**影響你的情緒 / 令你心煩**。」

Practice 37

> “The constant noise was starting to **get to me**.”

「持續不斷的噪音開始**令我受不了 / 影響我的情緒**。」

get to someone = 某件事逐漸影響某人的情緒、耐性或心理狀態

19. **get + someone/something** (抓到 / 找到 / 聯絡到) — 找到 ; 抓到 ; 聯絡上

Context determines the meaning.

Practice 38

> “The police finally **got** the suspect.”

「警方最後**抓到了**疑犯。」

Practice 39

> “I couldn’t **get** him on the phone.”

「我電話上一直**聯絡不到他**。」

get = 成功找到、抓到或聯絡到某人

This is one of the places where **get** is extremely context-dependent.

20. **get + transport (交通工具) — 搭乘 ; 乘坐**

Especially common in British English and conversational English.

Practice 40

> “We can **get the train** home.”

「我們可以**乘火車回家**。」

Practice 41

> “I usually **get the bus** to work.”

「我通常**乘巴士上班**。」

get + bus/train/taxi = 搭乘某種交通工具

Compare:

> take the train

> get the train

Both can be natural, depending on variety/context.

21. **get + meal/drink/service (取得 / 買來) — 買 ; 點 ; 拿**

Practice 42

> “Let’s **get some lunch**.”

「我們去**吃 / 買點午餐**吧。」

Practice 43

> “I’m going to **get a coffee**.”

「我要去**買 / 拿一杯咖啡**。」

get + food/drink = 買、拿、點或取得食物 / 飲品

Chinese translation depends heavily on context.

22. **get + message/call/email (通訊) — 收到**

Practice 44

> “Did you **get my message**?”

「你**收到我的訊息**了嗎？」

Practice 45

> “I **got a call** from the office.”

「我**收到辦公室打來的電話**。」

get communication = 收到某人的電話、訊息、電郵等

This is a contextual branch of **receive**.

23. **get + feeling/impression (感覺 / 印象) — 產生 ; 得到某種感覺 / 印象**

Practice 46

> “I **got the impression** that she was unhappy.”

「我**有一種感覺 / 得到一個印象**，覺得她不太開心。」

Practice 47

> “You **get a sense** of calm when you enter the room.”

「你進入房間時會**產生一種平靜感**。」

get an impression/sense = 從情況中形成某種感覺、理解或印象

24. **get + answer/information (查到 / 得到答案) — 找到 ; 取得**

Practice 48

> “I need to **get more information**.”

「我需要**取得更多資料**。」

Practice 49

> “Did you **get an answer**?”

「你**得到答案 / 收到回覆**了嗎？」

get information/answer = 成功取得所需資料、答案或回覆

25. **get + something + right/wrong (判斷 / 做法) — 弄對 / 弄錯**

Practice 50

> “I finally **got the answer right**.”

「我終於**答對了**。」

Practice 51

> “You **got my name wrong**.”

「你**把我的名字弄錯了**。」

get something right/wrong = 正確 / 錯誤地理解、記住或處理某件事

26. **get + something + ready/finished/done (完成 / 準備) — 弄好 ; 完成**

Practice 52

> “I need to **get** this report finished today.”

「我今天需要**把這份報告完成**。」

Practice 53

> “Let’s **get** everything ready before they arrive.”

「我們在他們到達前把所有東西**準備好**吧。」

get something + result state = 使某件事達到完成 / 準備好的狀態

27. **get** = experience/receive treatment (遭遇 / 受到某種待遇) — 遭到 ; 受到

Practice 54

> “The film **got** excellent reviews.”

「這部電影**獲得了**很好的評價。」

Practice 55

> “The idea **got** a lot of attention.”

「這個想法**受到**很多關注。」

get = 某人 / 事物受到、獲得某種反應、待遇或評價

Again, closely connected to **receive**.

28. **get** = persuade/affect so that something happens — 使 ; 令

Practice 56

> “The advertisement **got** me interested in the product.”

「那則廣告**令我**對產品產生興趣。」

Practice 57

> “The music **got** everyone excited.”

「音樂**令大家興奮起來**。」

****get + person + adjective = 使某人進入某種情緒 / 狀態****

This is related to both:

* causative get;

* get + adjective.

29. ****have got + noun (擁有) — 有 ; 擁有****

Extremely common, particularly in British English.

Practice 58

> “I’ve ****got**** a new pair of headphones.”

「我****有 / 買了****一副新耳機。」

Practice 59

> “Have you ****got**** any questions?”

「你****有****任何問題嗎？」

****have got = have = 擁有 / 有****

Important:

> “I’ve got a car.”

usually simply means:

****I have a car.****

Not:

****I have obtained a car**** in ordinary context.

30. ****have got to + verb (必須) — 必須 ; 得.....****

Another extremely common construction.

Practice 60

> “I’ve **got to leave** now.”

「我**現在得走了 / 必須離開了**。」

Practice 61

> “You’ve **got to try** these headphones.”

「你**一定要試試**這副耳機。」

have got to + verb = 必須 / 一定要做某事

Often conversational equivalent of:

> have to

31. **got = understood (口語回應) — 明白了**

Practice 62

> “Turn left at the station.”

> “**Got it.**”

「到車站後向左轉。」

「**明白了。**」

Practice 63

> “Don’t forget to send the file.”

> “**Got it.**”

「不要忘記傳送檔案。」

「**知道了 / 明白。**」

Got it = 我明白 / 收到指示了

This is extremely common conversational English.

32. **get it = understand — 明白 ; 懂**

Practice 64

> “I didn’t understand at first, but now I **get it**.”

「我一開始不明白，但現在我**懂了**。」

Practice 65

> “Do you **get it**?”

「你**明白了嗎**？」

get it = 明白某件事情的意思、原理或笑點

33. **get + age/stage/point (到達某個階段) — 到了；達到**

Practice 66

> “When you **get to** my age, you may understand.”

「當你**到了我這個年紀**，你可能就會明白。」

Practice 67

> “We’re **getting to** the difficult part.”

「我們正**進入 / 來到困難的部分**。」

get to + stage/point = 到達某個時間、程度或發展階段

This is metaphorically related to physical arrival.

34. **get = earn/achieve attention, votes, points, etc. — 獲得；取得**

Practice 68

> “The video **got** a million views.”

「這段影片**獲得了一百萬次觀看**。」

Practice 69

> “The team **got** three points.”

「球隊**取得了三分**。」

get = 在某種計量、競賽或反應中取得一定數量 / 成果

35. **getting** = process of becoming/obtaining (過程) — 正在變得 / 正在取得

Usually this is simply the -ing form, but it is worth recognizing because **getting** can represent several different senses depending on what follows.

Compare:

> “I’m **getting tired**.”

> = 我正在變累。

> “I’m **getting a new phone**.”

> = 我會取得 / 買一部新電話。

> “I’m **getting home late**.”

> = 我會很晚到家。

So **getting** itself has no one Chinese equivalent.

36. **gotten** = American English past participle — 已得到 / 變得 / 到達等

This is a crucial regional grammar point.

American English

> “The situation has **gotten worse**.”

「情況已經**惡化**。」

British English

Usually:

> “The situation has **got worse**.”

Both mean the same thing.

got vs gotten

This is one of the most important family distinctions.

British English

Past:

> got

Past participle:

> got

> “I’ve got better at it.”

American English

Past:

> got

Past participle often:

> gotten

> “I’ve gotten better at it.”

But American English still uses **got** in **have got = have**:

> “I’ve got two brothers.”

Not normally:

> *I’ve gotten two brothers*  if the meaning is simply “I have two brothers.”

37. **go-getter = ambitious, energetic person — 積極進取的人；很有衝勁的人**

A useful family extension.

Practice 70

> “She’s a real **go-getter**.”

「她是一個非常**積極進取、有衝勁的人**。」

Practice 71

> “The company is looking for ambitious **go-getters**.”

「公司正在尋找有野心、**積極主動的人才**。」

go-getter = 主動追求目標、充滿幹勁並積極爭取機會的人

This is a lexical family extension, not another sense of bare **get**.

Important distinction: **get home** vs **go home**

go home

focuses on movement toward home.

> “I’m going home.”

「我要回家。」

get home

focuses on **arrival**.

> “I got home at ten.”

「我十點到家。」

So your sentence uses **got home** because it describes the speaker **arriving home already exhausted**.

Important distinction: **get** vs **receive**

receive

more formal and specifically means something comes to you.

> “I received an email.”

get

broader and much more conversational.

> “I got an email.”

But **get** can also mean:

- * buy,
- * become,
- * arrive,
- * understand,

where **receive** cannot.

Important distinction: **get vs become**

become

formal/neutral change of state.

> “It became difficult.”

get

very common conversationally.

> “It got difficult.”

Both:

「事情變得困難。」

Get sounds more natural in everyday conversation.

Important distinction: **get vs arrive**

arrive

specifically means reach a destination.

get

broader and more conversational.

> “We arrived at the station.”

> “We got to the station.”

Both:

「我們到達車站。」

But:

> **get home** is very natural.

> **arrive home** is possible but less conversational.

Important distinction: **get vs buy**

buy

specifically means purchase with money.

get

means obtain somehow.

> “Where did you buy it?”

specifically asks about purchase.

> “Where did you get it?”

could mean:

* where did you buy it?

* who gave it to you?

* where did you obtain it?

So **get** is broader.

Important distinction: **get** vs **understand**

understand

neutral.

get

informal/conversational.

> “I understand the idea.”

> “I get the idea.”

Both:

「我明白這個意思。」

But **get** is especially common in speech.

Important distinction: **get** someone to do vs **make** someone do

get someone to do

= persuade/arrange/manage to cause them to do it

> “I got him to help.”

「我說服 / 叫他幫忙。」

make someone do

= cause/force them to do it

> “I made him help.”

「我迫 / 使他幫忙。」

Grammar:

> get + person + **to do**

> make + person + **do**

Important distinction: **get something done vs do something**

do something

you perform the action yourself.

> “I repaired the phone.”

「我自己修理電話。」

get something done

someone else does it for you.

> “I got the phone repaired.”

「我找人修理電話。」

Very important real-life grammar.

Important distinction: **get tired vs be tired**

get tired

= transition/change

「變累」

be tired

= state

「很累 / 處於疲累狀態」

> “I got tired after work.”

= 下班後我開始變累。

> “I was tired after work.”

= 下班後我很累。

Important distinction: **have got** vs **got**

I got a new phone yesterday.

= 昨天我取得 / 買了一部新電話。

I've got a new phone.

= 我現在有一部新電話。

The first describes **acquisition**.

The second usually describes **possession**.

Important distinction: **got** vs **gotten**

Variety / construction	Typical form	
-----	-----	
British past	got	
American past	got	
British past participle	usually got	
American past participle, change/acquisition	often gotten	
have got = possess	got in both varieties	

Examples:

> BrE: "She has **got** better."

> AmE: "She has **gotten** better."

But:

> "She has **got** a car."

= She has a car.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern **get** family includes:

* **get** — arrive = 到達

* **get — receive** = 收到 / 獲得
 * **get — obtain/buy** = 取得 / 買到
 * **get + adjective** = 變得.....
 * **get + illness** = 患上
 * **get + result/score** = 取得
 * **get + money/pay** = 收到 / 賺得
 * **get = understand** = 明白
 * **get someone something** = 替某人拿 / 買 / 取得
 * **get someone to do** = 使 / 說服某人做
 * **get something + adjective** = 使某物變成某狀態
 * **get something done** = 安排 / 請別人完成某事
 * **get + past participle** = 受到 / 進入某結果狀態
 * **get to do** = 有機會 / 獲准做
 * **get to someone** = 影響某人情緒
 * **get + transport** = 搭乘
 * **get + food/drink** = 買 / 拿 / 點
 * **get an impression/sense** = 產生某種印象 / 感覺
 * **get something right/wrong** = 弄對 / 弄錯
 * **have got** = 有
 * **have got to** = 必須
 * **got it** = 明白了
 * **get it** = 明白
 * **get to a stage/point** = 到達某個階段
 * **gotten** = 美式常見過去分詞
 * **go-getter** = 積極進取、有衝勁的人

And again, I have deliberately **not** expanded the huge phrasal-verb universe:

* get up
 * get out
 * get over
 * get through
 * get away
 * get along
 * get around
 * etc.

Those could fill an entirely separate lesson.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
* **get + destination**	經過移動後到達某個地方

get + object — receive	收到、得到或取得某樣東西 / 資訊 / 權利	
get + item — obtain/buy	透過購買或其他方式把某物取得到手	
get + adjective	從原本狀態轉變成另一種狀態	
get + comparative	某種性質隨時間變得程度更高 / 低	
get + illness	患上或感染某種疾病 / 健康問題	
get + score/result	在考試、比賽或評核中取得某項結果	
get + money/pay	收到薪酬、金錢或報酬	
get = understand	明白某個意思、概念、笑話或情況	
get someone something	替某人取得、買來或拿來某物	
get someone to do	透過說服、要求或安排使某人做某事	
get something + adjective	使某物進入指定狀態	
get something done — causative	安排 / 請別人把某件事情完成	
get something done — experience	自己的物件遭受某個動作或事件	
get + past participle	因事件而進入某種被動 / 結果狀態	
get to do	得到機會或被允許做某事	
get to someone	某件事逐漸影響某人的情緒或耐性	
get + transport	搭乘某種交通工具	
get food/drink	買、拿或點某種食物 / 飲品	
get an impression/sense	從情況中形成某種感覺、看法或印象	
get something right/wrong	正確 / 錯誤地理解、記住或處理某事	
have got	擁有 / 有	
have got to	必須 / 一定要	
got it	表示已明白指示或內容	
get it	理解某件事情的意思、原理或笑點	
get to a stage/point	到達某個時間、程度或發展階段	
gotten	美式英語中 get 在許多「取得 / 變化」意思下的過去分詞	
go-getter	主動積極追求目標、很有衝勁的人	

For your original sentence

> “...the train was so noisy and crowded that I often **got home** feeling exhausted.”

The exact meaning is:

got home = 經過通勤旅程後抵達家中

So naturally:

> ““I often got home feeling exhausted.””

= “「我經常回到家時已經覺得筋疲力盡。」”

And this sentence is a perfect example of why **get** deserved to be caught in our exhaustion scan: the source use looks completely ordinary, but the word itself has an enormous range of modern meanings and grammatical constructions.